

Where we are, and the two decisions that unlock everything else

Short version: the product is live, hardened, and verified end to end. The name research is done - you react to a shortlist instead of brainstorming. And the money question now has a written playbook with real numbers. Both decisions are ready to be made in one sitting.

1 What changed since the last brief

<https://vetpathusa.com>
Still the temporary address - it changes the day we settle the name (decision 1).

- **Sign in with Google** is live - one tap, no password to invent. (Microsoft sign-in is parked: it needs a personal Microsoft account to configure, which neither of us has.)
- **Accounts proven end to end** - a plan now survives refreshes, sign-outs, and brand-new devices. We found and fixed a real save bug, then verified the whole cycle live, twice.
- **The career test respects pay goals** - name a minimum salary and paths below it are pulled down and flagged with real BLS medians, never hidden.
- **Full usability audit shipped** - every screen walked as a first-time veteran; mobile fixes, a shorter intake with sensitive questions behind an optional fold, and clearer plan pages.
- **Phone flows polished** - Next stays at your thumb during the quiz, progress says "saved automatically," and someone who leaves mid-quiz gets a "pick up where you left off" card.
- **Privacy promise is self-serve** - "delete my data" now works from the profile page, exactly as the privacy policy promises.

2 Before we meet: ten minutes, on your phone

1. Open the address above and tap **Continue with Google** - account creation is now one tap.
2. Run the quiz *as yourself*, set a real pay target, and look at the plan it builds.
3. The only question: **does anything read as wrong to a veteran?** Write down anything that makes you hesitate to hand it to someone you know.

3 Decision one: the name - now a reaction, not a brainstorm

The research is done: 100 candidates generated, the strongest dozen deep-searched for collisions with veteran organizations and trademarks, and about 225 domains checked.

Shortlist	The one-line finding
Change of Station	Strongest new candidate - military-native phrase, clean searches, domains available.
Lodestar	Cleanest veteran space of the twelve - no veteran org, program, or tool found using it.
Due North	Zero veteran-space collisions, but the .com is unobtainable, a live trademark covers legal services, and it will be misheard as True North (an active veterans nonprofit).

The full workbook - all 100 names, findings with sources, sample logo marks, and domain availability for every candidate - is in your hands as an Excel file. Twenty candidates have both .com and .org open today. **Your job: gut reaction to the shortlist, then we pick.** I register the domain the same day.

4 Decision two: the money - the playbook is written

The nine-page funding playbook covers every option with published numbers: state veteran-assistance grants (\$200-300k awards in Texas), veteran foundations (~\$100k average, but they require two years of financial history), DoD SBIR contracts (\$75k-250k entry, for-profit only), organization licensing, and the revenue we refuse on trust grounds.

The fork	What it optimizes
Nonprofit path via fiscal sponsorship now	Maximum grant access and sustainability. Grant doors open in year 2-3 once the pilot produces countable outcomes.
For-profit path LLC now	Founder income and enterprise value: employers and government pay, veterans never do. SBIR is the door only this path can open.

The clean part: both paths keep "free for veterans, always" fully intact - so that debate is closed before it starts. The one question to settle between us: **what is this for - sustainability and grant access, or founder income?** The playbook's five closing questions walk the decision; everything else follows from the answer in one step.

5 What is open, and who owns it

- FRANK Ten minutes on the site, plus your gut reaction to the name shortlist.
- FRANK **Pick a pilot date** at your recurring meeting, and 5-10 veterans willing to use it in front of us.
- FRANK Settle the fork in section 4 with me - it decides which paperwork I file.
- KALEB Register the domain the day we pick the name; the real email service (password resets for everyone) and the custom web address follow within days of that.
- KALEB File the entity paperwork the fork points to, with an attorney and CPA sanity check first.
- KALEB Print packet for the pilot: gameplan leave-behinds, the worksheet, and this brief.

Still the thing that matters most: real veterans using this at your meeting. The name and the money both get easier after ten people have touched it. If our next session only produces a pilot date, it was a good session.

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